

The
Model for
Change

S t e p s F o r
C r e a t i n g
A P a r a d i g m
S h i f t I n
P e o p l e

E d u c a t i o n a l D i s c o v e r i e s

The Model_{for} Change

An Excerpt
Of Chapter 11 From

"The Model
For Change"

From The Book

*Choices for
Success: Your
Happiness In
Your Own Hands*

foa

The Model for Change

Okay, you have read this book and you love the information. Some of it is upsetting. Some of it sounds far out. But it FEELS true and satisfies something deep inside. And as you have read the book, you see things in your life that you would like to change. Ah, change! The very word can make our minds tremble. We all have to deal with change these days: we change, our friends change, our lovers change, our business changes, the economy changes, the world changes. How can we deal with all this change without going crazy? How do we carry through with a change that we desire to effect without getting sidetracked and losing our way?

This chapter is about how to change, the structure and nature of change and some tools to help us in the process. It is a map, as it were, for change: what works and what does not. The map is generic and is true for how change occurs in an individual, a relationship, an organization or a society.

You did the guided meditation. You reconnected with your purpose. In order to fulfill your purpose, it needs to be translated into a form that can be manifested. It needs to be made into a vision. Your vision is a picture of your soul's purpose brought to life. Your vision belongs to you. Other people may have similar visions and similar purposes but yours is unique to you.

Your vision will inspire you in times of despair and mundane boredom. It will be a light to steer by when your travel is clouded with fog. It will be a motivating force to empower you to grow, no matter how you feel, and it will keep you focused on the biggest picture possible.

What is your vision and how do you want to accomplish it?

Now, it may take more than a moment to create your vision and mission. When you do, the model for change will guide you through the changes you will need to make to have it happen.

The Model

Step 1 We *decide* to leave what is. The decision is made best with a clear vision and needs strong intention to carry it through. It does not matter if the change is prompted by an inner desire or an external situation. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We decide to lose ten kilograms	We decide to get married	We decide to implement employee quality control

Step 2 Whammo! And our inner *resistance* to the change hits us really strongly. We want to go back to where we were, even though we want to change. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We start to overeat	Our lover's annoying little habits become all we see	We begin to think our employees are incapable of controlling quality

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Step 3 Our decision to change and our resistance are equally balanced. If our decision were stronger we would just do it. If our resistance were stronger we would stop changing. This is a time when the *balance of order and chaos* (status quo and change) creates immense agitation. (Many people associate order with a positive situation and chaos with a negative one. In this model for change, the relative value has to do with the possibility for CHANGE. In the place of order there is no room for change. In chaos there is the option to change.) For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We hate ourselves for being fat but cannot seem to stop eating	We want to get married but are afraid it is a big mistake	We know that we want to implement the program but are afraid to give up our personal control

Step 4 If the agitation gets strong enough we move to a *choice point*—we either retreat to our history or move forward into the unknown. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Relationship
Keep the weight or lose it	Get married or not	Keep things the same or put in the new program

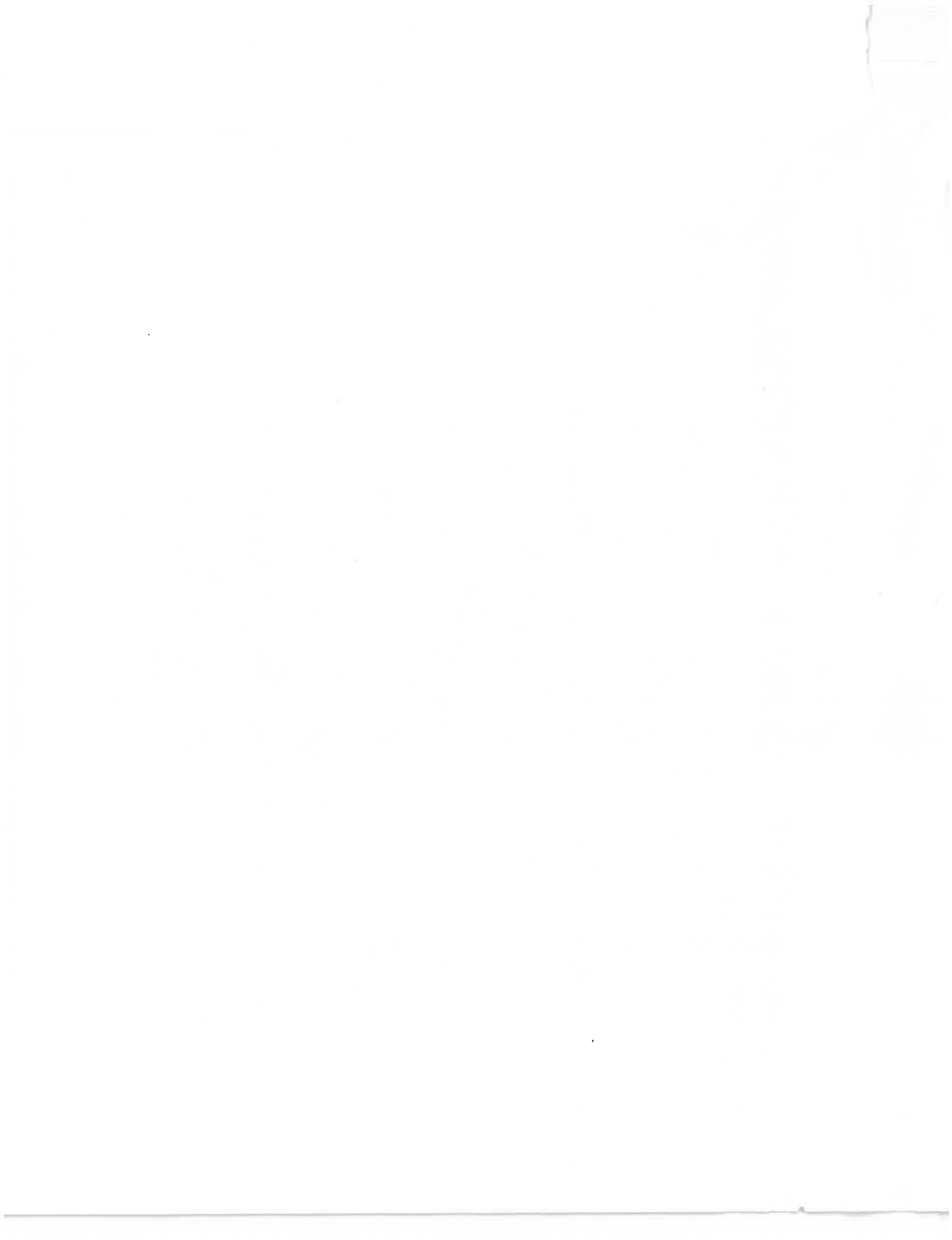
Step 5 Choosing to go for the past does not work. If the past were workable there would be no

need to change in the first place. It results in an *illusion*, a deception of ourselves. Either we deceive ourselves into thinking that the change was not necessary or we say that we have already accomplished it. The self-deception has a grave effect in that it erodes our self-esteem. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We buy larger size clothes; have our mother tell us we were too thin before	We decide that our lover is not marriage material but great for sex	We tell our selves and our employees they are responsible for quality but we do not act that way

Step 6 When we choose illusion often we cannot see what we are doing. We create a *crisis*. This is to wake us up to the changes we need to make. If we ignore the crises often enough, decay and death follow. On the other hand, we can be so shaken up by the crisis that we recommit ourselves to our intention to change, and mean it. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We have a heart attack. If the cycle continues it can result in death	Our lover leaves us. This can be repeated in relationship after relationship	Our employees become dispirited, lose respect for us, and production falls — could eventually mean business failure



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Step 7 The other option is to risk the unknown and do something new, to stay with our intention to change. This choice throws us into the *chaos of creation*: chaos because we feel all the feelings that were protected by our old pattern; creation because it is literally that. We are in new territory and we are choosing our reality from the raw material of our experience in the moment. When we do this, we are in *paradox*—the state of maintaining two seemingly opposite experiences at once. We feel pulled in opposite directions: one, the life of comfort, the old familiar way of behaving; the other, the pull to our vision, a new way of being. We must be able to contain the past and create the future simultaneously by the focus of our will to stay. It is tricky but it is the key to success. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We begin eating differently and exercising. All the feelings protected by the weight (anger, inadequacy, fear) are now felt	We plan the wedding. Even though we feel trapped, afraid, doubtful, not sure we want to be stuck with just one lover forever, afraid to be that vulnerable	We implement the worker quality control program. We feel how afraid we are that things will get really out of hand if we do not watch everything ourselves

Step 8 Chaos is extremely uncomfortable and the desire to bolt over to illusion becomes strong. Another *choice point* occurs. Will we go back or go on? It is now that *support* is critical—in the

middle of chaos. It is easy to lose sight of our vision of where we are going or to fool ourselves about where we are. Support from our peers who know our intention and vision helps keep us in that uncomfortable, fertile chaos of creation.

Step 9 If we stay in the chaos of creation long enough and maintain our experience (paradox), we come to the next step on the model for change—*responsibility*. We become the source of our experience and we accept all information without judgement. This is a *big deal*: *we change the way we see*. The same data mean something different than they did before. This allows for new solutions to old problems. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We understand the purpose the weight served: protection from getting hurt or from being seen as a sexual being	We see how much we want the relationship and how afraid we are to want that much	We see how the need to control covers a fear of not being good enough, and also great loneliness

Step 10 A curious thing happens at this point. We get so close to having what we want *we often stop* just short of actually reaching our goal because things are not as we pictured they would be. It may be that what we expected it to feel like or look like is not the way it is. Maybe we do not recognize it. Maybe we do not feel worthy to have what we want. Whatever our reason, many people, couples and businesses get

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98 percent of the way to their goal and stop. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
Our bodies are feeling good. People are starting to notice us. But we feel a loss and do not understand it	Our relationship is good. The wedding is upon us. But it not satisfying somehow	Our employees are really taking to the new system. Profits are up. We feel unnecessary

Step 11 At this point we need to remember what our intention was. We need to stay congruent. We need to use everything we have learned! So it is okay if it does not look and feel as we expected! We need to call for support. We need to see the pull of illusion. If we really take that support, we will *break through* to a place of success. We will be in *integrity*, in a state of totally unimpaired ability—true to our deepest self and able to do whatever we set out to do. For example:

Personal	Relationship	Business
We have compassion for our need for protection and realize that any change feels like loss for a while	We decide to be married, not just get married	We are free to be much more creative since we have responsible employees

become. But more importantly, it can support us to live with joy and self-respect.

EXERCISE:

Remember what your soul told you was your purpose for living? Ask it again. Your vision is the picture of your purpose brought to life.

If you were doing your purpose here what would it look like?

What would your body be like?

What would your relationship be like?

What would your business be like?

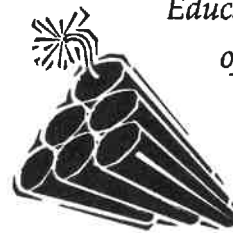
What business would you be in?

What changes would you be making in your life?

This model for change works. The more it is used the easier it gets and the more powerful we

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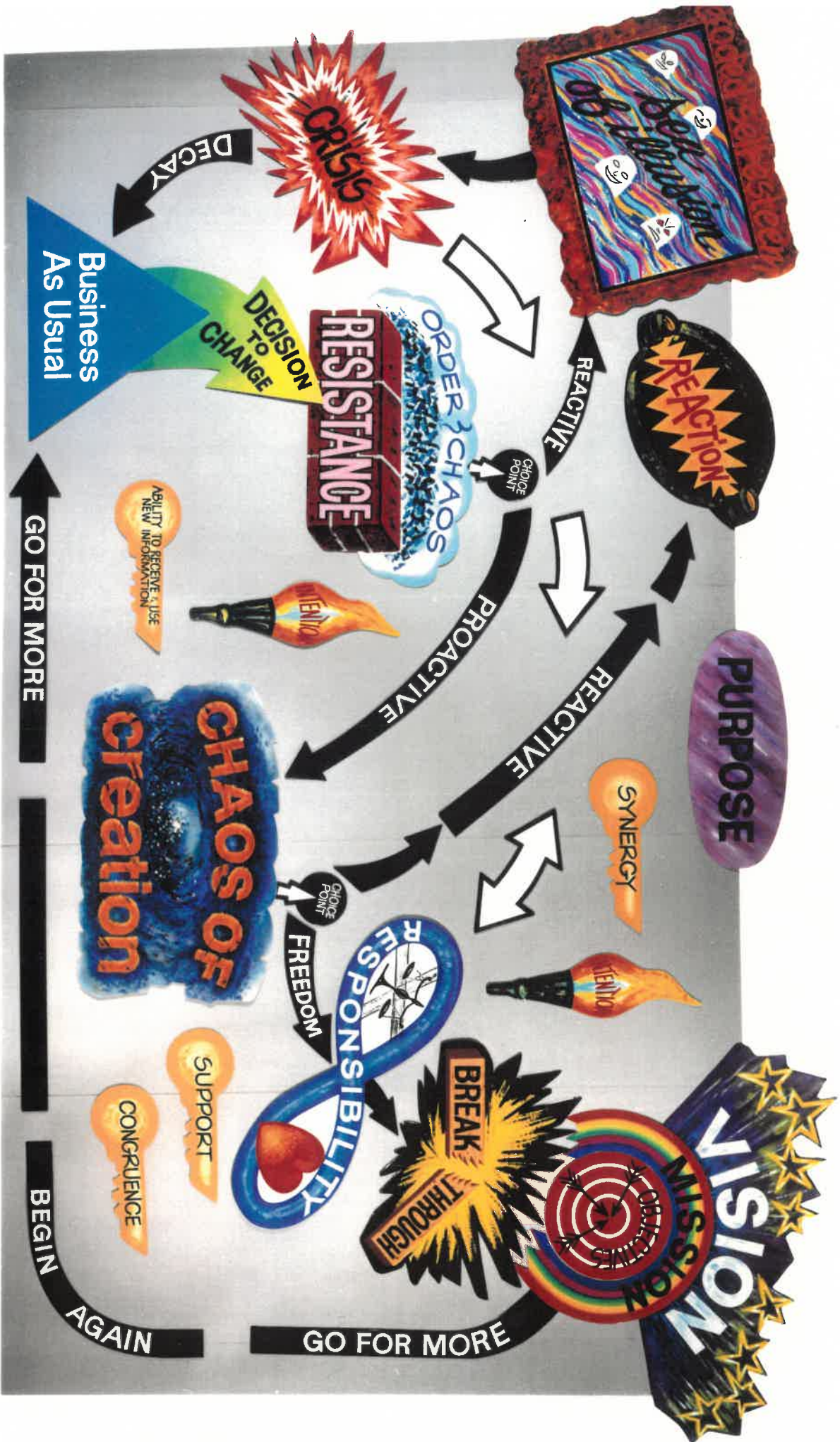


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THE MODEL FOR CHANGE[®]



The Model for Change

Heraclitus said, "The only constant in life is change."

Today, change is occurring at a more rapid pace than ever before. This is true in the relationships between countries, employees and employers, parents and children, or lovers and friends. These changes are happening so quickly that we need to become responsible and behave as free humans in order for success to have a chance.

Introduction

Whenever people make a change in how they behave, they go through a process that follows a path to a new vision of themselves.

That process is a challenging one no matter what the change is and no matter who's making it. Whatever the setting and whoever the person, knowledge of the change process is essential to managing the stress and chaos that change brings. When we make a change we rewire our point of view and how we experience a given situation.

That rewiring confuses our operating pattern, and takes us out of our comfort zone.

Successful change has a pattern. We call that pattern the Model for Change[©] and it has 10 steps.